LITTLE WONDERS ESL

History Word Lab: The Silk Road

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · a road for trade and ideas



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am a soft, shiny cloth that the Chinese made first. Traders carried me to the west.
2. We are groups of traders and animals who travel together across the desert.
3. We make food taste hot or sweet. Pepper and cinnamon are examples of us.

2 COOL FACT: TRADERS, CAMELS AND CARAVANS

The **Silk Road** was a network of trade routes between China and the Mediterranean Sea. It began more than 2,000 years ago. **Traders** travelled in groups called **caravans**, and **camels** carried the heavy loads. They carried **silk**, tea, **spices**, paper and gold. The journey was long and dangerous, so most traders did not travel the whole route. Goods passed from trader to trader. Ideas also travelled along the Silk Road, for example new inventions and religions. Cities such as Samarkand became rich.

network = many lines that connect

route = the way from one place to another

goods = things that people buy and sell

religions = beliefs about gods

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

T	M	T	E	G	R	C	M	T	C	N	A
P	K	T	C	S	T	T	A	L	H	E	E
A	S	I	L	K	H	R	C	D	I	R	N
P	E	A	C	A	R	A	V	A	N	O	S
E	F	S	A	A	U	D	O	N	A	U	P
R	C	T	C	A	M	E	L	I	E	T	I
E	C	N	A	O	C	R	O	I	O	E	C
U	H	R	I	I	C	M	F	S	S	O	E

WORD BANK

- ☐ silk
- ☐ caravan
- ☐ spice
- ☐ camel
- ☐ trader
- ☐ China
- ☐ route
- ☐ paper

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. What was the Silk Road?
2. What did traders carry?
3. Why did most traders not travel the whole route?